

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 12

Prefix ob-



Today I am learning that the prefix ob- often carries the idea against or in the way.

1 Learn the Meaning

The Latin prefix ob- often carries the idea against or in the way. In many modern words, the prefix is easiest to recognise by comparing related words and using the whole-word meaning.

obstruct
block / stand in the way

object
speak or act against

obstruction
something that blocks

objection
a statement against

2 Build the Word

Use the base or root clue and add the morpheme shown. Build the related word, then write a short meaning clue.

Base / root	Add	New word	Meaning clue
struct (build)	ob-		
obstruct	-ion		
obstruct	-ive		
object	-ion		
object	-or		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

Our student council was planning a new garden beside the library. The design looked good, but a narrow emergency path ran through the proposed area. This path was an obstruction, and it could obstruct people moving safely between the buildings. The group agreed that safety had to come first.

One student raised an objection to placing large planter boxes near the path because they would create an obstacle for anyone carrying equipment. After discussing the issue, the group decided to move the planters to a different spot. The revised plan removed the obstruction and kept the emergency route clear. The students noticed that an objection can be an idea raised against a plan, while an obstacle or obstruction can stand in the way.



Highlight the ob- words. Underline a related base or root clue when you can, then decide whether the word suggests against or in the way.

4 Word Detective

Choose one ob- word from the passage and investigate its structure, related words and meaning.

- Write an ob- word from the passage.

- What base, root or related word can you identify?

- Does the word suggest against or in the way?

- Explain how the word parts help you understand it.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by the meaning clue.

obstruct obstruction obstructive obstacle

object objected objection objector

In the way / blocking

Against / disagreeing

6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- An obstruction is something that _____

- Use object or objection in a sentence that shows disagreement.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the ob- meaning clue
- ☐ Distinguishes blocking from disagreeing meanings
- ☐ Uses a base, root or related word to investigate meaning
- ☐ Reads and uses target words in context



Capture idea:

Find an ob- word in a book, article or sign. Record the word, a related word and whether it suggests against or in the way.